DJANGO MODELS

Django's ORM is one of its most powerful features and it can benefit your website a lot if you know how to use it effectively

We talked a bit about Django's Object-Relational Mapper way back in the 'Starting with Django' chapter — seems ages ago now doesn't it! Now we actually use it in our project by designing how the CMS will structure its data in the database. In the previous chapter we talked about this structure, and in this chapter we turn that to code.

Before we do though we need to understand how the Django ORM works and how we can use it in our CMS.

Anatomy of a Django Model

A Django model is the Python-equivalent of a table in a database. A database table generally holds information about a single type of data, and Django allows us to configure the structure of this table using Python code.

To create a model in Django we simply need to create a Python class that derives from (i.e. extends / subclasses) Django's Model class and place it in the 'models.py' file in the app directory (in our case 'cms').

This class will have a number of attributes, each of which represents a column in the database. We can specify what kind of data is to be held in